the system itself need admin privileges so that they can prevent you from accidently messing up the vital hard or root coding of your machine and hence prevents you from messing your own system.

In the case of Ubuntu however, one has to use "sudo" or "gksudo" to gain privileges that are equivalent to administrative privileges on other systems. In other distros you switch to root or the super user which effectively does the same thing until you log out.

However you need to be vary of changing things in both of these situations because it can very well lead to programs not working, unintentionally changing ownership of the file from actual file owner to root user, and making your system less secure.

It is strongly recommended that you don't change the setting of system files until its necessary or you actually know what you are doing.

Extra Knowledge: Precedence in File Permission

Sometime or the other, there are going to be clashes in user, group and other ownership types. At that time, one question is bound to be raised in your minds, "what is the precedence in file permission used in Ubuntu?".

In Linux, the order of precedence goes from user to group and then at the last to other.

This means that Linux system checks who initiated the process, and the following order of precedence happens:-

- If the user who initiated the process is also the owner of the file, user permission bits are set.
- Next, Linux checks for the group permissions. If the user who initiated the process is in the same group as the owner group of files, then group permission bits are set.
- Lastly, if the user who initiated the process is neither the owner nor in the group, others permission bits are set.

Conclusion

File Permissions and Ownership are integral parts of Ubuntu and Linux system. Without understanding and knowing this skillset, there are only limited operations that a programmer can perform on a particular Ubuntu or Linux system. It is highly recommended from our side that you grab the basics right from the crux of it and keep practicing until you master them, because this is just one of those Linux essentials that you should know.